

In the Name of God
Call for Papers

Asia Cultural Dialogues
Cultural Diversity and converging aspirations in Asia

Tehran, 13-15, January, 2018

Cultural diversity, old traditions and ancient civilizations of Asia are an inspiring source for cooperation and convergence among different nations of the largest continent of the world. Boosting cultural ties and social bonds among nations and states in the region can strengthen Asian values and enhance convergence of their societies. To this end, the Islamic Culture and Relations Organization held the “International Conference on Dialogue among Religions and Cultures in Asia” (September, 2011, Tehran) in collaboration with the Majlis (Islamic Consultative Assembly of the Islamic Republic of Iran) and Asian Parliamentary Assembly. In the past several years, the Organization also took a number of initiatives for enhancing dialogue among cultures and religions in various parts of Asia in order to implement the tasks enunciated in the final resolution of the conference entitled “*Tehran Declaration on Dialogue among Religions and Cultures in Asia*”. Most notably, it established a secretariat of the international cultural dialogues in order to follow up the initiatives of the member states.

Now, the Secretariat of the International Cultural Dialogues decides to organize the Asian Cultural Dialogues with the presence of notable cultural figures and thinkers of Asia on 15-18, January 2018 in Iran in order to promote understanding, cooperation and convergence in Asia and eliminate increasing threats of violent extremism. Academics, researchers and the interested individuals are invited to develop and submit their academic papers on one of the following themes:

A. Cultural Diversity in Asia, opportunities and capacities for cooperation and convergence

1. Diversity of ethnicities and cultures in Asia; a capacity for peace and convergence
2. Ethnic and cultural identities and their role in Asian convergence
3. The impact of Globalization on cultural diversity in Asia
4. Cultural Diversity and their role in combating violent extremism
5. Cultural Diversity, Asian values and regional convergence
6. Solutions for boosting social coherence in multi-cultural societies

B. Cultural dialogue between Iran and the Subcontinent: spirituality and Sufism, opportunities and capacities

1. Mysticism and Sufism, an opportunity for enhancing cultural ties and boosting convergence
2. Role of Mysticism and Sufism in combating extremism and violence
3. Role of Mysticism and Sufism in promoting culture of peace and tolerance in Asia
4. Position of Mysticism and Sufism in historical and civilizational ties between the nations of the region
5. Role of Mysticism and Sufism in expanding tourism and increasing cultural exchanges

C. Cultural dialogue between Iran South East Asia and East Asia: cultural and historical ties

1. Common cultural heritage, a ground for cultural dialogues

2. Cultural and historical ties and their role in expanding the ties between Iran and South East Asia and East Asia
3. Cultural and historical ties, a ground for combating violent extremism
4. Cultural and historical ties and their role in expanding cultural tourism and enhancing cultural exchanges
5. Role of common cultural heritage in boosting cooperation between Iran and South East Asia and East Asia

D. Cultural dialogue between Iran and Central Asia and Caucasus: common cultural and historical heritage

1. Common cultural heritage, an opportunity for boosting regional cooperation
2. Role of cultural and historical symbols and figures of the region in boosting regional collaborations and strengthening cultural ties among the nations of the region
3. National policies for preserving, restoring and digitalizing the cultural heritage and their role in expanding cultural exchanges
4. Persian language and literature and their role in the cultural and historical ties of the region
5. Position of art and architecture in the common cultural heritage of the region
6. Assessment of national policies for maintaining the cultural structures and studying collective solutions for fighting the cultural heritage smuggling

E. Position of regional organizations in Asian convergence, scientific and educational collaborations in the field of ECO

1. Position of ECO Cultural Institute in expanding scientific and educational exchanges
2. Role of ECO Cultural Institute in coordination among policies for maintaining the common cultural heritage
3. Position of national encyclopedia foundations in scientific and cultural cooperations in the region
4. Position of national encyclopedia foundations in creating coherence among policies with regard to the common cultural heritage

The paper should be emailed to the conference secretariat before 20 November, 2017. The accepted papers will be edited and compiled in a collection which will be published after the conference.

Conference Location: The inaugural session and preliminary meetings will be held in Tehran and the panels of the conference will take place in other venues that will be notified to the participants.

The conference paper you submit

Contacts:

15 August, 2017